

Q Does that mean SDI is poised to replace IT administrators at a certain stage?

I would say that it is poised to make the IT administrator's life easy! With SDI coming in, an IT administrator should be able to spend much more time doing something more productive, like forecasts on how much resources he may need in the coming months. If businesses say that they need more resources in a specific month, for instance, in March, because maximum billing happens in that month, then IT is the one arm that has to arrange for the resources for this. So, in a way, SDI would make a systems administrator's life easy. SDI is a tool; it is not going to replace the traditional IT job, but will make that job more intelligent.

Q What is the demand like for SDI in today's data centres?

If someone is running a big data centre with thousands of servers and has to perform the same job on all the servers, then obviously he will run short of manpower at some stage. So, from that perspective, if I run big data centres, and if my data centre is SDI-enabled, I can make provisions for more resources and also release these resources once the job is done, automatically. SDI enables automation of data centres for resources, which is today done manually. Manual resource allocation is difficult, because most of the time, it is done only when some applications fail and the IT head comes to know that he needs to scale up his resources for that application. But can he make his software intelligent enough to reconfigure the resources based on those triggers? That is what SDI will handle. So, eventually, for all large data centres and servers, SDI is the answer.

Q It is said that data centres cannot be static any more. Do you agree? If so, please explain why.

'Static' implies having the same configurations all the time. So, it means that a User X retains the set configurations assigned to him initially, all the time. That is not the case any more. Till two years back, whatever was given to User X was fixed. The data centre guys used to delete the resources assigned from the 'resources table' after they were assigned, which is not the

case now. So, when a provision of resources is made in the current scenario, the provision is made based on dynamic needs. It means that when the need is there in a specific month or a time period, the resources are automatically provisioned. The resources are also provisioned based on triggers. For example, if the IT head sees the RAM running out of stock for a specific application, the servers will pull out more RAM from the virtualised infrastructure and give it to that particular application, automatically. This is the concept of a dynamic data centre.

In the traditional IT space, things were different, but now, the clients are offered a choice between a static or a dynamic set-up. Static set-ups have a higher billing, because that configuration is assigned specifically to a company, only to be used by that company. But in the case of a dynamic set-up, it means that as and when the company is not using those assigned resources, some other firm might use it as well. Yet, the data centre will ensure that the terms of the SLA signed with the company are met and the configurations cannot drop below the set SLA. What we see as a trend is that dynamic set-ups are more in demand because they require less intervention, take less time to provision and are need-based.

Q So how is SDI evolving in India?

Today the telecom sector is a high adopter of SDI, and enterprises have started following suit. Going forward, there is bound to be a huge paradigm shift in the enterprise data centres and e-commerce data centres, and as I said, telecom has already taken the lead because it is largely in the Internet hosting space as well.

Q Do we see SDI entering the SMB space anytime soon?

Not really. It is more related to who wants the infrastructure. SMBs today usually go for the infrastructure-as-a-service (IaaS) model, which is ideally someone else's infrastructure. SMBs either want to have their own infrastructure, which could be a small compute infrastructure, or it is based on somebody who is servicing them, which is IaaS. SDI is more effective when you use a large number of servers and storage. **END** 

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